Bronagh McAlinden

Head of IT Operations

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SUMMARY

Twenty-two years in IT operations, starting on the service desk and now managing a small team that runs infrastructure for a law firm. Hands-on when needed, focused on continuity, security and good relationships with the business. I enjoy building teams and mentoring people who are starting out in IT; two of my former service desk staff are now senior engineers. I sit on the firm's risk committee as the technology representative.

SKILLS

Windows Server, VMware, Microsoft 365, Active Directory, Backup and DR planning, Cisco Meraki, ITIL, Vendor management, Budgeting, Cyber Essentials

EXPERIENCE

Head of IT Operations, Lagan & Sloan Solicitors — 2015 – Present

- Manage a team of four administrators and an outsourced security provider.
- Led a data centre exit to a colocation facility and a refreshed virtual environment, completed over a weekend with no data loss.
- Own the disaster recovery plan, tested annually with partners.
- Achieved Cyber Essentials Plus certification for three consecutive years.
- Managed an annual budget of 1.4 million pounds and negotiated vendor contracts that saved 12% year on year.
- Introduced a clear incident and change process aligned with ITIL, cutting repeat incidents by a third.
- Report quarterly to the partners on availability, incidents, security posture and project progress.
- Select and manage managed-service partners, with clear service levels and regular reviews.

Senior Systems Administrator, Antrim Retail Holdings — 2008 – 2015

- Administered servers, email and point-of-sale back-office systems.
- Introduced centralised patching and imaging for 300 PCs.
- Planned and led a major email platform migration for 900 users with minimal disruption.
- Wrote the firm's information security policies and ran awareness training.
- Supervised a team of six on the helpdesk and server support, with weekly coaching sessions.

Service Desk Analyst, Belfast Council IT — 2004 – 2008

- Handled 40 tickets a day and escalated server issues.
- Learned how a service desk works in a large public body, including escalation and customer care.

EDUCATION

- BSc Information Technology, Ulster Lakes University (2000 – 2004)

LANGUAGES

English (native), Irish (A2)

CERTIFICATIONS

- ITIL 4 Foundation